Vellore Institute of Technology-Bhopal

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Branch – Computer Science Core

Year- First Year

Course Code- CSE0001

Date – 31 March 2026

Introduction

As a newly selected **Student Digital Ambassador**, I was tasked with building a comprehensive portfolio to showcase digital competency to both a faculty committee and my fellow batchmates. The scenario required me to move beyond basic internet usage and instead focus on creating professional profiles, communicating effectively, and recognizing cyber threats. This project serves as a roadmap for my four-year academic journey, ensuring that my digital footprint is both secure and professional. By working through five distinct modules—ranging from design to cybersecurity—I have established a verified online presence that bridges the gap between being a student and becoming a career-ready professional.

Task 1 Write-up: Digital Literacy Infographic

For this task, I used **Canva** to design a one-page visual resource aimed at my peers. My design focused on three critical pillars: the definition of digital literacy, essential tools for engineering students (like GitHub and HackerRank), and safe internet practices. I chose a clean, modern layout to ensure the information was digestible at a glance. What I found most interesting was the challenge of "visual hierarchy"—deciding which information was important enough to be big and bold versus what could be in a smaller font. I realized that while we consume information visually every day, creating a resource that actually teaches someone something requires a high level of intentionality. It forced me to think like a teacher rather than just a designer.

Task 2 Write-up: Professional Platform Strategy

I chose to set up my foundational presence on **GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle**. GitHub serves as my primary technical repository, where I can share code and collaborate on open-source projects. LinkedIn acts as my professional identity hub, allowing me to connect with industry mentors and track internship opportunities. Kaggle, meanwhile, is my data science playground where I can practice analytical skills using real-world datasets. Over the next four years, I plan to use these tools in a tiered approach. My first two years will be spent documenting coursework on GitHub and taking LinkedIn Learning courses to fill skill gaps. By my third and fourth years, I intend to use Kaggle to compete in global challenges and LinkedIn to actively network for placement season, ensuring that recruiters see a consistent history of growth.

Task 3 Write-up: Coding & Collaboration Practice

To practice technical problem-solving, I used **HackerRank**, where I completed the beginner-level 'Python Introduction' challenge. This helped me get comfortable with competitive coding syntax and automated testing environments. For the collaboration portion, I built a 5-question 'Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz' using **Google Forms**. The quiz included a mix of multiple-choice and short-answer questions designed to test a student's ability to identify a phishing email and their understanding of multi-factor authentication. These tools will be invaluable academically because they encourage a "practice-first" mindset. HackerRank prepares me for technical interviews, while Google Forms is a practical tool for gathering data for research projects or organizing club events within the university.

Task 4 Write-up: Professional Communication

I researched a scenario where a student missed a major internship deadline because they sent an inquiry email without a subject line, which caused it to be automatically filtered into the recipient's spam folder. This "poor communication" resulted in the student losing a career-defining opportunity simply because they lacked basic email etiquette. To avoid this, I learned that every professional email must have a clear, concise subject line and a structured body. I practiced this by drafting two professional emails: one requesting an extension and another inquiring about an internship. The key takeaway is that online communication is often the only impression a recruiter has of you; clarity and respect in your digital voice are just as important as your technical skills.

Task 5 Write-up: Cybercrime Awareness

While researching **UPI/Online Payment Fraud**, I was genuinely surprised to learn how many scams rely on "social engineering" rather than technical hacking. Specifically, I discovered that many victims are tricked into entering their UPI PIN under the guise of "receiving" a prize, which is technically impossible. This highlights that our greatest vulnerability isn't our software, but our own lack of awareness. As a result, the one habit I will personally change is **enabling 2-Factor Authentication (2FA)** on every single account I own, especially my primary email and payment apps. I have also saved the **1930 Helpline** number in my phone to ensure I can act immediately if I ever suspect a breach.

Conclusion

This project has shifted my perspective from being a passive user of the internet to an active, professional participant in the digital world. I have learned that digital literacy is a combination of technical skill, professional etiquette, and constant vigilance. By building this portfolio on GitHub, I now have a permanent record of my commitment to these principles that will grow alongside my engineering degree. Overall, I feel better prepared to represent **VIT Bhopal** as a Digital Ambassador and to navigate my future career with confidence and security.

Google form link:

https://docs.google.com/forms/d/e/1FAIpQLSfetARMKLLczLL0p2uMPTc_UBbVopp02bZkmO3kTlddirr6Qg/viewform?usp=publish-editor